



Questionnaire: Barro Group - BQC Quarries & Burdekin Concrete

MN-60011

Deadline to respond: Wednesday, 6 May 2026

The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (**ACCC**) is currently assessing Barro Group Pty Ltd's (**Barro**) proposed acquisition of the quarry and concrete business and specified assets operated by Colevale Estates Pty Ltd, M&T Populin Pty Ltd, Twin Rock Pty Ltd, BQR Registrations Pty Ltd, BQC Sands Pty Ltd, and Burdekin Concrete Pty Ltd (the **Sellers**) (the **Acquisition**).

Barro will acquire the Sellers' hard rock and sand quarrying operations in Burdekin and Bowen in Northern Queensland, as well as Burdekin Concrete, which manufactures ready mix concrete in Burdekin (the **BQC/Burdekin assets**).

For further information about the ACCC's assessment of the Acquisition, see the ACCC's [Acquisitions Register](#).

The ACCC is assessing the impact of the Acquisition on competition and is seeking your views. The ACCC invites you to provide submissions or information in response to the questions below by **5pm on Wednesday, 6 May 2026** via email to mergers@acc.gov.au with the title *Submission re: Barro Group - BQC Quarries & Burdekin Concrete*. The ACCC must complete its assessment within strict statutory timelines which also impacts the time available for consultation.

If you would prefer to speak to a member of the ACCC case team, please email mergers@acc.gov.au with the title *Request for call re: Barro Group - BQC Quarries & Burdekin Concrete*. Someone from the case team will contact you to find a suitable time for a call.

Please note that:

- This request is made in accordance with section 51ABZZD(2)(a) and (c) of the *Competition and Consumer Act 2010* (Cth) (the **Act**). This means that while the ACCC may take into account submissions or information received after the due date, it is not required to do so.
- In responding to the questions below or when providing a submission, please highlight and/or mark any confidential information and indicate why the information is confidential (as brief reasons in footnotes in your response or submission, or in a separate document such as the ACCC's [confidentiality claims template](#)). The standard terms on which the ACCC accepts confidential information are outlined at the end of this document.

Questions

In this questionnaire:

Coarse Sand Products means sand with a maximum particle size of 5mm.

Hard Rock Products means crushed rock with a particle size over 5mm.

RMX means ready-mix concrete.

1. Provide a brief description of your business or organisation, including any quarries or RMX plants you operate, the type of aggregate or concrete products you supply and/or purchase, and any commercial relationships you have with Barro, the BQC/Burdekin assets or the Sellers.

Sand quarries

Barro operates a sand quarry on the Haughton River and the BQC/Burdekin assets include sand quarries at Mount Kelly and Ayr/Home Hill.

2. How closely do Barro and the BQC/Burdekin assets (together, the **Parties**) currently compete in the supply of Coarse Sand Products in the areas set out above? In your response:
 - a. For each of the Parties' quarry locations (Haughton River, Mount Kelly, and Ayr/Home Hill), describe the typical geographic distance (in kilometres or driving time) over which customers can efficiently source Coarse Sand Products.
 - b. Describe how transport costs, or other factors (such as site access, or product type or quality), influence customer choice between the Parties as suppliers of Coarse Sand Products.

3. Identify and describe the main competitors to Barro and the BQC/Burdekin assets in the supply of Coarse Sand Products in the area surrounding the Parties' respective quarries.

4. If you are a Coarse Sand Products customer of the Parties and were to stop sourcing from them, is it possible to switch your entire requirement to an alternative supplier? Please explain any costs (including transport costs), time delays, or technical barriers associated with making such a switch.

5. To what extent is sand containing clay a commercially viable substitute for sand which is naturally free of clay in RMX production? In your response, please describe:
- a. Any additional costs which would be incurred in order to process sand containing clay for RMX production.
 - b. Any specific applications or projects where 'refined' clay-containing sand would not be an acceptable substitute for sand that is naturally free of clay.

Hard rock quarries

Barro operates a hard rock quarry in Black River and the BQC/Burdekin assets include hard rock quarries at Airville and West Euri, Bowen.

6. How closely do the Parties compete in the supply of Hard Rock Products in the areas set out above? In your response:
- a. For each of the Parties' quarry locations (Black River, Airville and West Euri, Bowen), describe the typical geographic distance (in kilometres or driving time) over which customers can efficiently source Hard Rock Products.
 - b. Describe how transport costs, or other factors (such as site access or product quality), influence customer choice between suppliers of Hard Rock Products.

7. Identify and describe the main competitors to Barro and the BQC/Burdekin assets in the supply of Hard Rock Products in the areas surrounding the Parties' respective quarries.

8. If you are a Hard Rock Products customer of the Parties and were to stop sourcing from them, is it possible to switch your entire requirement to an alternative supplier? Please consider any costs (including transport costs), time delays, or technical barriers associated with making such a switch.

RMX

Barro operates a RMX plant in Bohle, northern Townsville, and the BQC/Burdekin assets include a RMX plant in Ayr.

9. How closely do the Parties currently compete in the supply of RMX in the areas set out above? In your response:
- For each of the Parties' RMX locations (Bohle, northern Townsville, and Ayr), describe the typical geographic distance (in kilometres or driving time) over which customers can efficiently source RMX.
 - Describe how transport costs, or other factors (such as site access or product quality), influence customer choice between the Parties as suppliers of RMX.

10. Identify and describe the main competitors to Barro and the BQC/Burdekin assets in the supply of RMX in the area surrounding the Parties' respective RMX plants.

11. If you are a RMX customer of the Parties and were to stop sourcing from them, is it possible to switch your entire requirement to an alternative supplier? Please consider any costs (including transport costs), time delays, or technical barriers associated with making such a switch.

12. If you are a competing supplier of RMX, do you currently purchase Coarse Sand Products and/or Hard Rock Products from quarries operated by either of the Parties? If so, please identify the relevant quarry/s and product type/s.

13. Are there alternative quarries located close enough to your RMX plant/s to provide a competitive alternative to the Parties' products in terms of both volume and grade?

For all product categories

14. Outline any concerns you have regarding the impact of the Acquisition on competition.

15. Provide any additional information or comments that you consider relevant to the ACCC's assessment of the Acquisition.

Confidentiality of responses

During the ACCC's assessment of a notified acquisition, the ACCC may receive information that is properly regarded as being confidential, and which is provided to the ACCC in confidence. The ACCC is committed to treating this information responsibly and in accordance with the law. The ACCC understands the importance of confidentiality to parties involved in a notified acquisition, as well as to third parties that provide information to the ACCC.

The standard terms on which the ACCC accepts confidential information are:

- there is no restriction on the internal use, including future use, that the ACCC may make of the confidential information consistent with the ACCC's statutory functions
- confidential information may be disclosed to the ACCC's external advisors and consultants on condition that each such advisor or consultant will be informed of the obligation to treat the information as confidential, and
- the ACCC may disclose the confidential information to other third parties if compelled by law or in accordance with section 155AAA of the Act. This includes disclosures made in the performance of official duties or functions, which include transparency requirements which are part of the merger control regime.

For further information on confidentiality, see the ACCC's [interim merger process guidelines](#).